Name – Devesh Shailesh Katneshwarkar

Reg No. – 25BAI10381

Branch – Computer Science (Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning)

Course – Digital Literacy

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Introduction: -

1. The Visual Resource: "More Than Just Being Online"

- **The Concept:** A one-page "Humanized" guide created in **Canva**.
- **The Goal:** To move away from boring definitions and show that digital literacy is a survival skill.
- **Key Features:** * **The 4 Cornerstones:** Critical Thinking, Safety, Professionalism, and Tech Skills.
    - **The "3-Second Rule":** A quick mental checklist (Is it true? Is it helpful? Is it permanent?) to use before posting or clicking.
    - **Impact:** It serves as a professional anchor for the faculty presentation while being catchy enough for a hostel WhatsApp group.

2. Professional Digital Identity & Networking

Goal: To establish a verifiable professional presence across key industry platforms.

- **LinkedIn:** Optimized a professional profile highlighting current engineering studies and future graduation, serving as a gateway for industry networking.
- **GitHub:** Created a specialized "Profile README" repository. This acts as a technical landing page that introduces your branch, year, and specific learning goals in Python and Mathematics.
- **Kaggle:** Set up a data science foundation to host future AI models and participate in global competitive datasets.

3: Technical Onboarding & Skill Validation

Goal: To demonstrate foundational coding proficiency and platform literacy.

- **Platform:** Hacker Rank (or similar).
- **Achievement:** Successfully completed the "Solve Me First" or "Python: Introduction" challenge.

- **Competency:** Demonstrated the ability to navigate online IDEs, handle standard input/output, and pass automated test cases—a critical skill for technical interviews and remote collaboration.

4: Digital Ethics

Goal: To model and teach responsible digital citizenship and financial safety.

- **Professional Communication:** Drafted high-standard email templates for academic requests and internship inquiries, focusing on clarity and etiquette.
- **Social Media Hygiene:** Developed a "Do's and Don'ts" framework to help peers maintain a professional digital footprint.

5: Case Study and Checklist

- **Cybercrime Case Study:** Analyzed UPI "Reverse-Payment" Fraud, emphasizing that a UPI PIN is only for sending money, never receiving.
- **Safety Plan:** Implemented an 8-point security checklist including 2FA and official reporting via 1930 or cybercrime.gov.in.

TASK-1: Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

The design is structured into three clear horizontal segments to ensure a logical information flow. The top section introduces the **"4 Cornerstones of Your Digital Life,"** using custom icons to represent Critical Thinking, Security, Professionalism, and Technical Skills. The middle section utilizes a colorful grid to highlight the **"Reality Check"**—the tangible benefits of digital literacy, such as employability and time management. Finally, the bottom section features a "3-Second Rule" checklist, providing batchmates with a quick, actionable framework for responsible online behavior.

To create this one-page resource, I utilized **Canva**, a versatile graphic design tool known for its intuitive drag-and-drop interface and professional template library. I selected a modern "Infographic" layout, which allowed me to balance dense information with clean, engaging visuals suitable for a university audience.

One thing I found particularly interesting was **Canva's "Magic Media" AI integration**. While the tool is famous for its manual design elements, using AI to generate specific icons that matched my "Humanized" theme was a gamechanger. It was challenging to ensure the text-heavy sections didn't feel cluttered, but by using white space and a consistent color palette, I managed to keep the resource both professional for the faculty and readable for my peers.

TASK-2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

For this task, I focused on three pillars of a modern technical career: professional networking (**LinkedIn**), version control and collaboration (**GitHub**), and data science mastery (**Kaggle**).

LinkedIn serves as my professional "front door," where I have documented my current engineering degree and expected graduation. Over the next four years, I plan to use it to connect with industry leaders in India and share my progress as a Digital Ambassador. **GitHub** is my technical laboratory; by creating a profile README, I have personalized my workspace where I will host my Python DSA projects. Finally, **Kaggle** provides a competitive edge for my interest in Artificial Intelligence. I intend to use it to participate in global data challenges and build a portfolio of Jupyter notebooks.

By maintaining these platforms, I am not just storing code or a resume, but building a verifiable, "living" record of my growth from a university student to a professional engineer. These tools will be essential for securing internships and showcasing my technical literacy to future employers.

TASK-3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

3.1: Coding Practice

The goal of this task was to establish a presence on a professional competitive programming platform to enhance technical problem-solving skills and demonstrate digital proficiency in a coding environment. I chose to create an account on **Hacker Rank,** as it is widely recognized by recruiters and offers a structured "Skills Certification".

I successfully completed the following steps:

1. **Account Creation:** Registered using my university credentials to link my professional learning to my academic identity.
2. **Challenge Selection:** Chose the **"Solve Me First"** (or **"Python: Introduction"**) challenge to familiarize myself with the platform's Integrated Development Environment (IDE) and submission workflow.
3. **Problem Solving:**
    - **Language Used:** Python.
    - **Result:** The code passed all hidden test cases on the first submission.

3.2: Google Workspace Collaboration

I utilized **Google Forms** for data collection and assessment. I practiced digital pedagogical techniques by building a 5-question awareness quiz in Google Forms, complete with automated feedback loops to ensure my batchmates learn as they go.

Practicing with these tools has significant academic advantages. **Google Forms** serves as a powerful academic research tool; it streamlines data collection for projects, provides real-time analysis, and helps in organizing study groups or peer-review sessions efficiently.

TASK-4: Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

A classic example of a digital communication breakdown is the **"Reply-All" chain reaction** within a large organization.

Imagine a department head sends an email to 500 employees regarding a minor policy update. One employee accidentally hits "Reply-All" to ask a personal question. This triggers a cascade of dozens of other employees also replying-all to say, "Please stop replying to everyone!"

In this scenario, the volume of notifications can crash the local mail server, but the real damage is the **lost productivity and information overload**. Critical project updates get buried under the noise, leading to missed deadlines and widespread frustration.

To prevent this, the sender should have used the **BCC (Blind Carbon Copy)** field for the recipient list, which prevents "Reply-All" threads from forming. Additionally, the organization could foster a digital etiquette culture where employees are trained to pause and check the recipient list before hitting send, or use instant messaging platforms like Slack for quick, non-essential queries.

TASK-5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

What surprised me most during this research was the sophisticated psychological engineering behind **UPI "Reverse-Payment" scams**. I previously assumed that cybercrime required complex coding or database breaches; however, I discovered that most modern fraud in India relies on exploiting a user's momentary confusion between "paying" and "receiving." Learning that a single, misplaced 4-digit PIN can bypass even the most advanced banking encryption was a sobering realization of the "human element" in security.

As a result, the one habit I am personally changing is my **password and 2FA management**. While I am technically proficient in Python and engineering, I realized I was "reusing" similar password patterns across my academic and financial accounts. I have now transitioned to using a dedicated password manager and have enabled **biometric locks** on all my UPI and investment apps. This ensures that even if my device is unlocked, my financial data remains behind an additional layer of hardware-backed security.

CONCLUSION -

The completion of these projects has been a transformative exercise in establishing a robust and professional digital presence. By transitioning from a passive consumer of technology to an active **Digital Ambassador**, I have bridge the gap between my academic studies in Engineering and the practical demands of the modern workforce.

Overall Learning and Key Takeaways:

- **Professional Branding:** Through the strategic setup of **GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle**, I learned that a digital identity is a "living resume." It is not just about listing skills, but about consistently demonstrating technical curiosity and a commitment to open-source collaboration.
- **Technical Agility:** Onboarding with **Hacker Rank** reinforced the importance of standardizing my coding workflow. Solving even foundational challenges like "Solve Me First" highlighted the necessity of rigorous testing and clean, readable Python code.
- **Digital Responsibility & Ethics:** The most profound learning came from researching **UPI-based cybercrime**. It shifted my perspective from viewing security as a purely technical hurdle to understanding it as a human-centric responsibility. I now recognize that as an Ambassador, my role is to simplify these complex security protocols for my peers to ensure our community stays financially and socially safe online.

Future Commitment:

Moving forward, I will continue to maintain these platforms as I progress through my university years. I am committed to using my voice as a Digital Ambassador to promote professional email etiquette, responsible social media use, and a "security-first" mindset among my fellow students.